

CONTENTS

Prologue

[On the Plumage of Birds](#)
[What You Do Not Know](#)
[Experts and “Empty Suits”](#)
[Learning to Learn](#)
[A New Kind of Ingratitude](#)
[Life Is Very Unusual](#)
[Plato and the Nerd](#)
[Too Dull to Write About](#)
[The Bottom Line](#)
[Chapters Map](#)

PART ONE: [UMBERTO ECO’S ANTILIBRARY, OR HOW WE SEEK VALIDATION](#)

Chapter 1: [The Apprenticeship of an Empirical Skeptic](#)

[Anatomy of a Black Swan](#)
[On Walking Walks](#)
[“Paradise” Evaporated](#)
[The Starred Night](#)
[History and the Triplet of Opacity](#)
[Nobody Knows What’s Going On](#)
[History Does Not Crawl, It Jumps](#)
[Dear Diary: On History Running Backward](#)
[Education in a Taxicab](#)
[Clusters](#)
[Where Is the Show?](#)
[8¾ Lbs Later](#)
[The Four-Letter Word of Independence](#)